

ALEX CHEN

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SUMMARY

Senior Staff Engineer with 9+ years building distributed systems for high-throughput notification, messaging, and engagement platforms. Led architecture and execution of multi-region, event-driven platforms processing 800M+ daily events. Practical depth in Kafka, Redis, Go, and Python; comfortable across the JVM. Mentor to four engineers. Joined Pageform Jan 2023; promoted to Senior Staff Sept 2024.

EXPERIENCE

Pageform — Senior Staff Engineer · San Francisco, CA

Sep 2024 — Present · (Staff Engineer 2022 — Sep 2024)

- Technical lead for Reach, Pageform's customer notification platform handling ~800M sends/day across email, push, SMS, and in-app channels.
- Led migration from polling to event-driven architecture (Kafka backbone, Redis-backed dedup, Temporal for scheduling). Reduced p99 send latency from ~4s to under 600ms.
- Architected and shipped "smart batching" notification system; integrated a small ranking model to bundle/suppress redundant pushes. Drove 23% lift in CTR and 31% drop in unsubscribe rate.
- Owned multi-region failover for Reach. Investigated and resolved a 90-second window during regional cutover that led to ~4M duplicate sends; introduced replication-lag-aware failover and cross-region reconciliation journaling.
- Mentor to four engineers (two Senior, two Mid). Run weekly architecture office hours for the broader Reach team.

Tessera Health — Senior Software Engineer · Boston, MA

2017 — 2020

- Senior IC on the Patient Messaging team; designed and led rewrite of the secure delivery layer to scale past 50M daily HIPAA-compliant messages.
- Drove migration from Redis Streams to Kafka; architected the consumer side (in partnership with Staff Eng who owned the producer/contract side).
- Promoted from Engineer II to Senior Engineer in 2019.

Hexel Labs — Software Engineer · Pittsburgh, PA

2015 — 2017

- Backend engineer on developer-tooling startup. Shipped CI cache, build-graph dependency analyzer, and the first iteration of the multi-tenant artifact store.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Reach Smart Batching** — Inference-path integration for a small ranking model to debounce notification floods. Worked closely with Applied ML on latency budget.
- **Webhook Batching API** — Re-architected per-event webhooks into a batched stream after large-customer feedback; pushed back internally on the "customer should consolidate" alternative.
- **API Versioning Push** — Argued and won (against initial PM resistance) for a versioned delivery-status API instead of a breaking change; preserved contract trust with long-tail customers.
- **Linkerd adoption (and rollback)** — Championed Linkerd for service mesh; admitted in writing nine months later that I had under-weighted operational cost; led the rollback.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University — M.S. Computer Science, 2015

University of Michigan — B.S. Computer Science, 2013

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGIES

Go (primary), Python, Kotlin (rusty), Java (rusty), TypeScript · Kafka, Redis, Postgres, DynamoDB, Temporal · AWS (primary), GCP · Kubernetes, Terraform, OpenTelemetry